

December

14

1812

Retreat in the cold

The French invasion of Russia, led by Napoleon Bonaparte, ended after almost six months, with the last of the French forces leaving the country. The French

were not prepared for the brutal Russian winter and left defeated.



Born this day

1918 BKS Iyengar, Indian yoga instructor. He introduced a version of yoga that focused on precision and alignment in postures.

South Pole

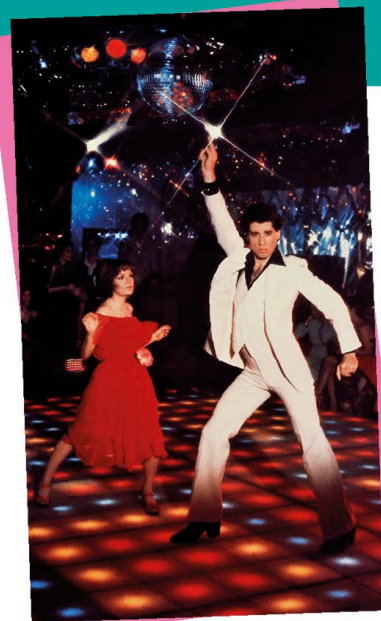
In the race to reach the South Pole in Antarctica, Norwegian explorer Roald Amundsen and his team were victorious, planting their country's flag in celebration on arrival. They reached the pole 33 days before the British expedition led by Robert Falcon Scott.

1911

1977

Saturday Night Fever

The world premiere of *Saturday Night Fever* took place in Los Angeles, USA. The film's dance sequences made a star of young actor John Travolta.



Also on this day

1962 NASA's robotic probe *Mariner 2* became the first spacecraft to fly by Venus.

1985 **Wilma Mankiller** was sworn in as the Principal Chief of the Cherokee Nation. She was the first woman to lead a major Indigenous American tribe.

1994 Work began on the **Three Gorges Dam** on the Yangtze River in China. It harnesses hydroelectric power from the river, and is now the world's largest power station.

